continue to influence borders. These include agreements with Nepal, Bhutan, China, Tibet, Afghanistan, and Myanmar. But British agreements were often problematic, vague, error-strewn, and repeatedly revised, contributing to many of the boundary disputes that India still faces. India's western boundary with Pakistan—the Radcliffe Line—was marked in a rather haphazard and rushed manner by British civil servants, adding to the trauma of Partition. Similarly, the Durand Line separating Afghanistan from British India and the McMahon Line separating what is now Arunachal Pradesh from Tibet both remain politically relevant today. [84] Beyond borders, it was during the British colonial period that India developed its current military and bureaucratic structures. Due to the belated addition of Indians to the civil service and officer cadre of the military, India inherited a bureaucracy and military from the British. India still retains many of these organizational features, including its regimental traditions and a generalized civil service. [85]

Much of the British colonial legacy had a lasting effect on independent India: from the judicial system and civil service to the army and infrastructure. But for the most part, these institutions were meant for extractive purposes, a consequence of which was the immense transfer of wealth from India to Britain during the period of the Raj. The extensive Indian railway network, for example, was designed primarily to transport raw materials and troops and was heavily subsidized by Indian taxation. Under British rule, agricultural policies in India were often disastrous and industrialization was suppressed, resulting in almost no per capita economic growth in India between 1900 and 1947. [86] The struggle for Independence from British rule was therefore both a moral and practical necessity for Indians.

Power, Trade and Ideas: Lessons from Pre-Independent India

The history of India's interactions with the world before Independence makes it possible to derive several lessons relevant to the present day. At least three stand out. First, India's long history shows the persistence of